RECENT REAL · 10.10.2026 · 1-SMENA

Writing Task 1

Dear Member,

From next month, our swimming pool will be closed for approximately three months while essential repair work is carried out. As part of the project, we will also create a larger and more modern fitness area. The work will be expensive, but members will not be asked to pay any additional fees.

We understand that the closure may affect some members and would be grateful to receive your views and suggestions.

Kind regards,
The Center Manager

Task 1.1 — Informal letter
Write a letter to your friend, who is also a member, telling them about the closure, giving your opinion, and suggesting what the center should do.
Write 50-70 words.

Task 1.2 — Formal letter
Write a letter to the center manager expressing your views on the planned changes and suggesting how the center could support members while the swimming pool is closed.
Write 120-150 words.

Writing Task 2

Variant A

Some people believe that tourism has a positive impact on the natural environment, while others argue that it causes serious environmental problems. Discuss both views.

Post your response, discussing both views and giving reasons and examples. Write 180-200 words.

Variant B

Some people believe that tourism brings great benefits to local communities, while others argue that it causes damage to the places people live.

Post your response, discussing both views and giving reasons and examples. Write 180-200 words.

Model answers

SAMPLES FOR SELF-STUDY — TRY TO WRITE YOUR OWN ANSWER FIRST.

Task 1.1 · B2 level (68 WORDS)

Hi Anna,

I've just got an email from our sports centre. The swimming pool will be closed for about three months because of repairs, and they will also build a bigger fitness area. I think it's a pity, because I swim every week, but a modern gym sounds great. In my opinion, the centre should give us discounts at another pool. What do you think?

Write soon, Tom

Task 1.1 · C1 level (63 WORDS)

Hi Anna,

Have you heard the news? Our sports centre is closing the pool for three months for essential repairs, and a larger fitness area will be added. Although I'm delighted about the upgrade, I'll miss my weekly swim terribly. Frankly, the centre ought to arrange free entry to a nearby pool in the meantime. Shall we suggest it together?

Best wishes, Tom

Task 1.2 · B2 level (138 WORDS)

Dear Manager,

I am writing about your email on the closure of the swimming pool and the new fitness area.

First of all, I understand that the repairs are necessary, and I am happy that members will not have to pay extra. A larger and more modern fitness area will also be useful for many people. However, I am worried about three months without a pool, because swimming is my main way of keeping fit.

I would like to suggest some ways to support members. For example, the centre could make an agreement with another pool in the city so that we can swim there at a lower price. In addition, you could organise extra fitness classes and give us a free month when the pool reopens.

I hope you will consider my ideas.

Yours faithfully, Tom Brown

Task 1.2 · C1 level (143 WORDS)

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing in response to your recent email concerning the temporary closure of the swimming pool and the creation of a new fitness area.

While I fully appreciate that essential repairs cannot be postponed, and I am grateful that no additional fees will be charged, I am concerned about losing access to the pool for three months. For many members, myself included, swimming is a vital part of a healthy routine.

I would therefore like to propose a few measures. Firstly, the centre might negotiate a partnership with a nearby pool so that members can swim at no extra cost. Secondly, additional fitness classes could be scheduled to compensate for the closure. Finally, an extended membership once the work is complete would be a generous gesture.

I trust that you will consider these suggestions.

Yours faithfully, Tom Brown

Task 2 (A) · B2 level (191 WORDS)

Tourism is often described as a source of income, but its effect on nature is a topic of real debate.

On the one hand, tourism can help to protect the environment. Entrance fees to national parks and reserves pay for rangers, cleaning and wildlife programmes. Local people also see that a healthy forest or beach is valuable, so they have a reason to preserve it. In some countries, tourism money has saved endangered animals from hunting. For example, many national parks in Africa depend on visitor fees to protect lions and elephants.

On the other hand, large numbers of visitors can seriously damage fragile places. Tourists leave rubbish, walk off the paths and disturb animals. Hotels and airports use a great deal of energy and water, and flights produce a lot of pollution. In popular areas the sea and the coast often become dirty and overcrowded.

In my opinion, tourism can be good for nature only if it is carefully controlled. For example, governments should limit the number of visitors, ban plastic and teach tourists to respect the places they visit. If this happens, both people and the environment can benefit.

Task 2 (A) · C1 level (183 WORDS)

The relationship between tourism and the natural environment is far more nuanced than either camp tends to admit.

Supporters argue, with some justification, that tourism gives nature a price tag. Revenue from park fees and eco-lodges frequently funds conservation work that governments would never afford, and communities that profit from wildlife have little incentive to poach it. Costa Rica's protected forests are often cited as proof that preservation and profit can coexist.

Critics, however, point to the unmistakable damage caused by mass travel. Coral reefs are trampled, trails are eroded and local wildlife is displaced by construction and noise. In addition, local water supplies are often diverted to resorts, leaving nearby villages short. Moreover, the carbon footprint of long-haul flights quietly undermines whatever good a single reserve achieves.

In my view, the outcome depends not on tourism itself but on how it is managed. Strict visitor quotas, high environmental standards for hotels and a genuine share of profits for local residents can turn a threat into an ally. Without such regulation, however, the very landscapes that attract visitors risk being destroyed by them.

Task 2 (B) · B2 level (193 WORDS)

Tourism has become one of the biggest industries in the world, and people disagree about what it does to local communities.

Those who support tourism say that it creates jobs and brings money into poor areas. Local people can work in hotels, restaurants and shops, or sell traditional crafts and food. The income can also pay for new roads, schools and hospitals that everyone can use.

However, there are real disadvantages. When many tourists arrive, prices of housing and food often go up, so residents cannot afford to live in their own neighbourhoods. The streets become crowded and noisy, and traditions can lose their meaning when they are performed only for visitors. Sometimes the biggest profits go to foreign companies, not to local families. For example, a small guesthouse owner can hire neighbours and buy food from local farmers.

I believe that tourism is useful when the community has a say in how it develops. For instance, small family guesthouses and local guides keep money in the area, and rules can protect quiet residential zones. With sensible planning, tourism can improve life for local people instead of damaging the places where they live.

Task 2 (B) · C1 level (198 WORDS)

Few industries divide opinion in host communities as sharply as tourism, and both sides have a valid case.

Proponents emphasise the economic lifeline it provides. In regions with few alternatives, visitors sustain entire networks of guides, drivers, artisans and restaurateurs, and the tax revenue they generate can finance infrastructure that residents would otherwise lack. Samarkand and Bukhara, for example, have restored historic districts largely thanks to visitor income.

Detractors counter that the benefits are rarely distributed fairly. Rents soar as homes are converted into short-term lets, long-standing residents are priced out, and everyday life is reshaped around the needs of strangers. Cultural practices may also be reduced to staged performances, losing their authenticity. Tour operators based abroad often capture the largest share of the profits, leaving residents with low-paid seasonal work.

On balance, I would argue that tourism is neither a blessing nor a curse in itself. A balanced policy would therefore measure success by residents' wellbeing, not only by visitor numbers. Its impact is determined by governance: caps on holiday rentals, incentives for locally owned businesses and genuine consultation with residents can ensure that growth enriches, rather than erodes, the communities that make a destination worth visiting.